Research with AI Agents

What Works, What It Costs, and What an Institute Needs

Lukas Theissinger

October 30, 2026

Outline

Staying Up to Date with AI

OpenAI and “Use Agents”

Owning Intelligence and Infrastructure at Lamarr

What to Watch in the Near Future

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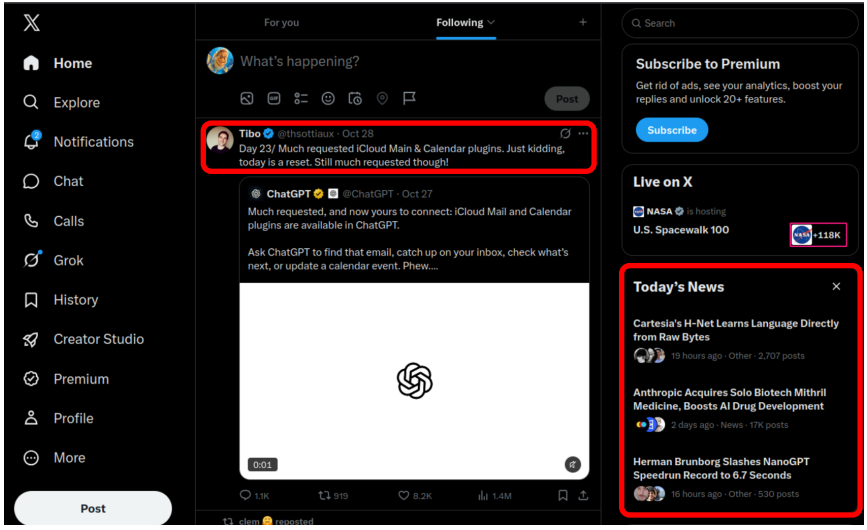
How to Stay Up to Date

1. **Make an X (Twitter) account.**
   Many people from the frontier labs post there first, often daily.

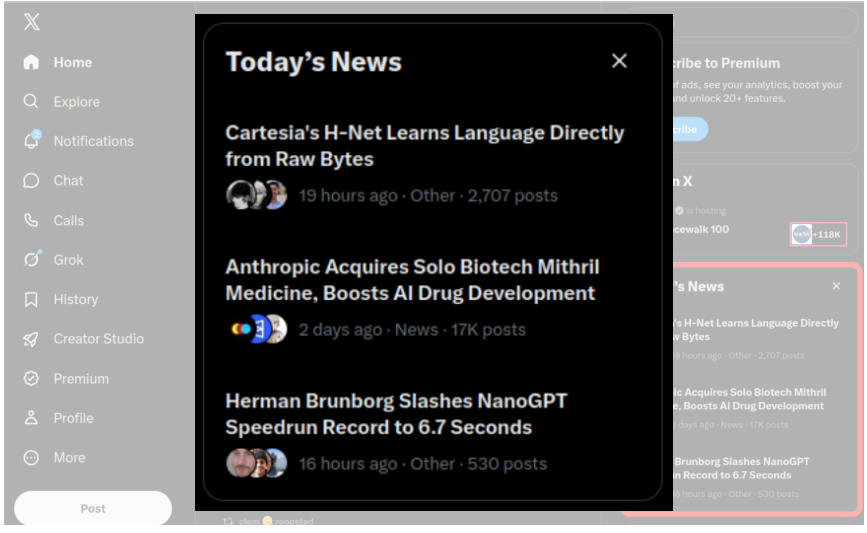
2. **Read "Today's News" on the home page.**
   It sums up the biggest updates of the day.

3. **Follow the right people.**
   Don't be fooled by clickbait.

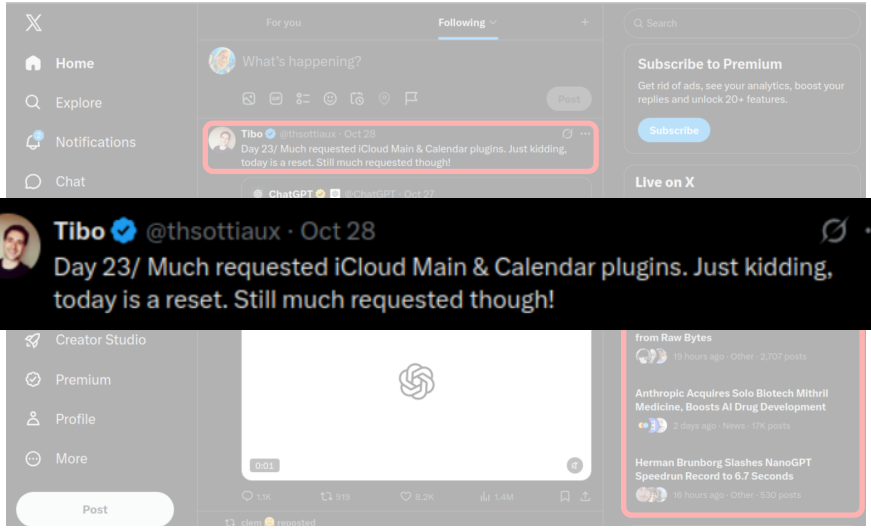
Read Today's News



Read Today's News



Read Today's News



Tibo @thsottiaux · Oct 28

Day 23/ Much requested iCloud Main & Calendar plugins. Just kidding, today is a reset. Still much requested though!

Who to Follow and Why

Who	Handle	Why
Andrej Karpathy	@karpathy	Clear explanations of LLMs and how to work with them
Thibault Sottiaux (tibo)	@thsottiaux	Leads OpenAI Codex; news on Codex releases and usage limits
Boris Cherny	@bcherny	Created Claude Code; how Anthropic uses its own agents
Tim Dettmers	@Tim_Dettmers	Agents in academic research; open models on small budgets
Victor Taelin	@VictorTaelin	Tests frontier models on hard coding problems
Felix Rieseberg	@felixrieseberg	Builds Claude's desktop apps at Anthropic; early product news

A few of the 251 accounts I follow, all of this kind.

A Recent Headline You Might Have Missed



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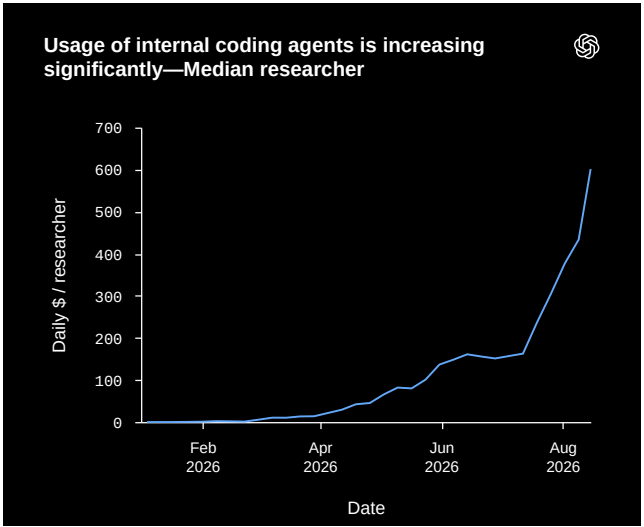
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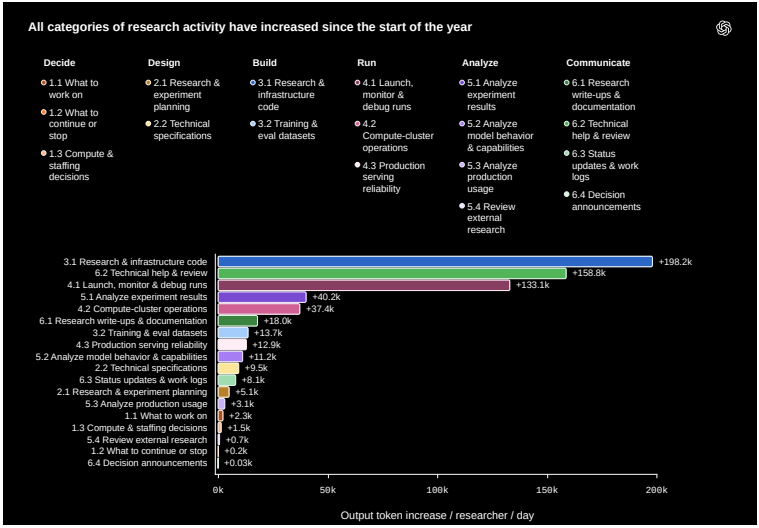
What to Watch in the Near Future

FOMO Headline: OpenAI Agent Usage



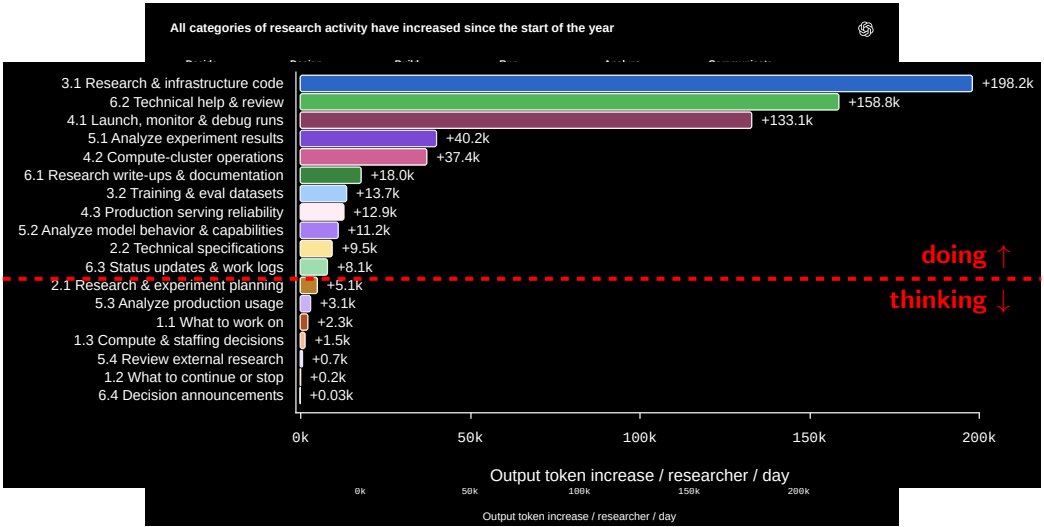
Median researcher, daily $ spent on internal coding agents. Source: OpenAI, "Research acceleration" (self-reported).

What do agents do at OpenAI?



Increase in output tokens per researcher per day, by research activity. Source: OpenAI, "Research acceleration" (self-reported).

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Use Agents or Be Left Behind

Tim Dettmers, January 2026

Dettmers' Interpretation

Tim Dettmers' hypotheses, read against the OpenAI usage data

Dettmers says	**What the OpenAI chart suggests**
"More than 90% of code and text should be written by agents."	Agents took over the *doing*: code, runs, technical help are ∼75% of the extra tokens.
His posts are $>$ 95% AI, but he still dictates (1 h) and reviews (2 h).	Did agents take over the *thinking*? The chart can't say: a plan or a decision is short, so tokens are the wrong measure.
Automate only if how often $\times$ time saved $>$ time to build.	Frequent, repetitive work grew most; rare decisions grew least.
Agent use is a *skill*: practice, expect failures (his email agent: 100+ h, net negative).	All 18 activities went up: agents are used everywhere, but how much and how exactly is still open.

Sources: timdettmers.com/2026/01/13/use-agents-or-be-left-behind; OpenAI, "Research acceleration" (self-reported).

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Small Labs Can Compete

What It Costs

What an Institute Needs

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Near-Term Developments

Bend 2

Takeaways